lists and US naval patrols. In doing so, Lashkar displayed enormous clout in terms of its ability to produce fake passports, safe houses, guards and fixers.[121] One captured Lashkar operative alleged that the group also provided medical support to Arabs wounded during the US counter-attack.[122] This support was not ad hoc, according to an interrogation report of foreign and Pakistani nationals arrested in Punjab in March 2002. Lashkar operatives admitted they were directed to facilitate safe haven and safe passage for al-Qaeda cadres and other fugitive Arabs.[123] Tariq Pervez, the former Director General of Pakistan's Federal Investigation Agency, reaffirmed the belief that this was an organizational directive.[124]

Lashkar has a history of proffering safe havens to jihadi fugitives from justice. It is reported to have given refuge to Mir Aimal Kansi, who was ultimately caught and convicted for murdering two and wounding three employees of the US Central Intelligence Agency in a shooting outside its headquarters in Langley, VA. The group also allegedly allowed Ramzi Yusuf, the mastermind behind the 1993 World Trade Center attack and nephew of Khalid Sheikh Mohammed, to hide in one of its Muridke guesthouses in order to avoid a police dragnet.[125] This hospitality continued after 9/11. Gary Schroen, who led the first CIA team into Afghanistan after 9/11, stated that local jihadi groups, and primarily Lashkar, were running most of the safe houses in which al-Qaeda members were caught in the early years of the decade in Pakistan.[126] According to Ahmed Rashid, who was covering the story at the time and has written extensively about the post-9/11 environment in the region, the government suppressed most of the evidence regarding these arrests and the Pakistan army exerted heavy pressure on the local media not to report them. This was particularly the case when Lashkar was involved.[127]

Abu Zubaydah [born Zayn al-Abidin Muhammad Hussein] remains the most notable operative captured at a Lashkar safe house. In his pre-9/11 role as a logistician, Abu Zubayda had worked closely with Lashkar and it was in one of the group's safe houses that he was captured in March 2002. The CIA station in Islamabad had learned the previous month that Zubayda was in either Lahore or Faisalabad, and US officials sought to narrow the search by tracking Zubayda via his mobile phone. They were able to identify fourteen possible locations in both cities, all of which were put under surveillance. On 28 March the Punjab Police's Elite Force led